

Implementation Roadmap

Sequence pilots, wins and scaling steps

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

An Implementation Roadmap is a phased plan for embedding a design or change into an organisation — sequencing pilots, visible early wins, capability-building and scaling — with owners, milestones and metrics. It turns a validated concept into an adoption journey.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Drawn from change-management and innovation-adoption practice (e.g. Kotter's change model applied to design thinking).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Validated ideas stall in organisations without a deliberate adoption plan. A roadmap sequences the political and practical steps needed for change to survive contact with the business.

HOW IT IS USED

Define the end state and metrics, then plan pilots, quick wins to build momentum, capability development, and staged scaling, assigning sponsorship and ownership throughout.

WHEN IT IS USED

The implementation stage, after a solution is validated.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Change leaders, innovation managers and executives.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO PRIOR PRACTICE

It reframes design thinking's final step as **organisational change, not a hand-off**, connecting method to lasting adoption.

FIGURE 1 · PHASED ADOPTION

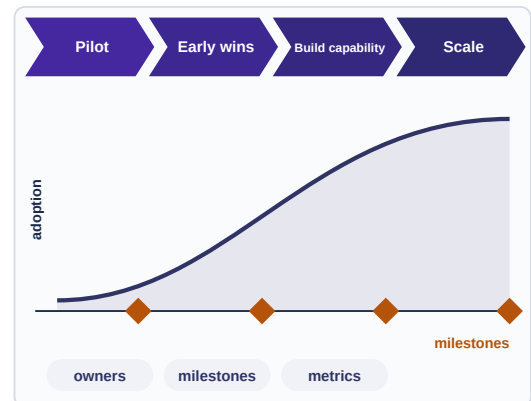


Figure 1. Pilots and visible early wins build the capability that lets a validated idea scale, gated by milestones.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Define Success *Slibrary 10*

Critical Items Diagram *Slibrary 6*

Context Mapping *Slibrary 6*

SOURCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Kotter, J.P. (1996) *Leading Change*. Boston: Harvard Business School Press.

Liedtka, J. (2018) 'Why Design Thinking Works', *Harvard Business Review*, 96(5), pp. 72–79.